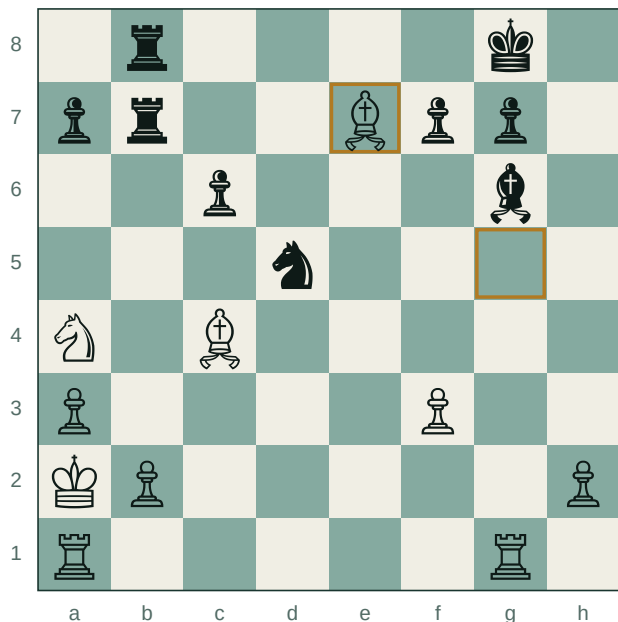


Calculated sacrifices: Black, move 24

Calculated sacrifices

Black to move



Previous move: 24.Bxe7. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

24...Rxb2+ 25. Nxb2 Nc3#

24...Rxb2+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. The move also takes the pawn on b2. Recorded reply: **25.Nxb2**.

25...Nc3# Mate: knight on c3 gives check; White has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on a2. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Knight on c3. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

An attractive attacking picture is not compensation by itself. Continue until the resulting position can be evaluated honestly.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A sacrifice exchanges material for a concrete benefit. The benefit may be mate, a stronger attack, a recovered investment, or lasting activity; it must be shown through moves.

HOW TO LOOK

State what the sacrifice changes: a defender, a line, a king square, or a critical tempo. Calculate acceptance and plausible refusal.

The defending king is on a2. Geometrically undefended: bishop on e7 and bishop on c4. Check for tactical protection.